

PO Box Rental API — two open questions

To	Emirates Post PO Box API team
From	7X — NXN conversational assistant
Environment	<code>https://box-stg.emiratespost.ae/services/pobox</code> (staging)
Date	30 August 2026

We have the rental flow working end to end against staging, with one exception and one design question. Everything below is from live calls on staging, with the customer's own UAE PASS session token as the bearer.

1. Rental/Save cannot find a hold that Rental/Select just created

This is the blocker. `Select` succeeds and returns a reference; `Save` rejects that same reference seconds later, in the same session.

The hold — succeeds

```
POST /api/v1/Rental/Select
{
  "bundleId": "IN",
  "uniqueBoxID": "2450364",
  "poBoxExpiryDate": "2027-08-29T00:00:00+00:00"
}
```

```
200 OK
{ "payload": {
  "subscriptionReferenceNumber": "260611701",
  "minimumAmount": 370.0,
  "subscriptionReferenceNumberExpiryDate": "2026-08-30T15:07:10+00:00"
} }
```

The save — rejects it

```
POST /api/v1/Rental/Save
{
  "subscriptionReferenceNumber": "260611701",
  "totalAmount": 370,
  "requestSource": "PoBoxAIBot",
  "userProfile": {
    "customerNameEN": "...", "mobileNumber": "...",
```

```

    "email": "...", "idNumber": "784...", "idType": "EmiratesID"
  },
  "paymentProperties": {
    "paymentReturnUrl": "https://...",
    "saveCreditCard": true,
    "isAutomaticSubscriptionEnabled": true,
    "billingDetail": { "firstName": "...", "lastName": "...", "emailAddress": "...",
                      "address": "Dubai", "cityName": "Dubai",
                      "countryName": "United Arab Emirates" }
  }
}

```

```

400 Bad Request
{ "errorDetails": {
  "RESPONSE_CODE": "157",
  "ERROR_CODE": "157",
  "ERROR_MESSAGE": "ERROR_GETTING_HOLD_DETAILS",
  "RESPONSE_MESSAGE": "SYSTEM SYSTEM ERROR: PLEASE CONTACT SUPPORT TEAM"
} }

```

The same payload **sometimes succeeds** — we have created real orders this way (260961735 , 260961739) — and sometimes returns 157. We cannot see what distinguishes the two.

What we'd like to know

1. Is `subscriptionReferenceNumber` from `Select` the value `Save` expects, or is a different identifier intended?
2. Is any call required **between** `Select` and `Save` ?
3. Does the hold need anything we are not sending — `holdReferenceNumber` , `physicalBoxRequired` , `orderNumber` ?
4. Is there a timing or session constraint that would explain intermittent 157s?

2. `Save` opens its own payment — can a rental paid elsewhere be recorded?

On success, `Save` returns a hosted payment page and an N-Genius order on **your** outlet:

```

200 OK
{ "payload": {
  "orderNo": "260961739",
  "custProfID": "6542907",
  "paymentGateWayResponse": {
    "paymentUrl": "https://paypage.sandbox.ngenius-payments.com/v2?code=...",
    "referenceNumber": "4d1e9cc3-670c-45ca-9084-6496100afdf0",

```

```
"niOrderResult": { "outletId": "b78ef8c7-ce2a-41d6-84c9-e6219557a991", "...": "..." }  
}  
} }
```

We take payment on **our own** N-Genius outlet, so yours is never settled:

```
POST /api/v1/Rental/UpdatePayment/4d1e9cc3-670c-45ca-9084-6496100afdf0  
200 OK  
{ "payload": { "orderNumber": "260961735",  
               "isPaymentSuccess": false,  
               "paymentDetails": { "amountPaid": 0.0 } } }
```

The N-Genius order stays at state `STARTED`, and **the box does not appear in the customer's portal** even though the rental record exists.

What we'd like to know

1. Is there a way to record a rental as **already paid** — a flag, a different endpoint, or a payment reference we can pass in?
2. If not, is the intended flow for the customer to pay on the `paymentUrl` you return, and for us to poll `UpdatePayment/{referenceNumber}` until `isPaymentSuccess` is `true`?
3. Roughly how long after payment does `isPaymentSuccess` flip? We need to know how long to wait before telling a customer anything.

Three things we found by trial — please confirm they're intended

#	Finding	Why it matters
1	Select needs <code>uniqueBoxId</code> from <code>FreeBoxes</code> (e.g. <code>2450364</code>), not <code>boxId</code> (<code>450364</code>). Sending <code>boxId</code> returns <code>108 BOX_NOT_FREE</code> .	<code>BOX_NOT_FREE</code> reads as "someone else took it". We were telling customers boxes were unavailable when they were free and we'd sent the wrong identifier.
2	<code>paymentProperties.billingDetail</code> is optional in the spec but required in practice . Omitting it returns <code>400 {"Error":"Error from payment gateway"}</code> .	The error names the gateway, not the missing field, so it reads as an outage on your side.
3	<code>UpdatePayment</code> takes <code>paymentGateWayResponse.referenceNumber</code> . Passing <code>niOrderResult.reference</code> — also a UUID, in the same response — returns <code>500 Internal system error</code> .	Two UUIDs side by side with nothing to distinguish them.

Other observations

- **Rental/Save takes ~17 seconds** (measured: 16.95s). `Select` returns in under a second. Is that expected? We've raised our client timeout to 60s.
- **Rental/Bundle** takes `request=P` (personal) / `request=C` (corporate), not `EmirateCode`. With `EmirateCode` it returns 400.
- **FreeBoxes needs a customer session** — 401 with the API key alone.
- **LocationId must be the branch's own officeId**, not `mainOfficeId`. Naif is `officeId 214` / `mainOfficeId 209`; `209` returns an empty list rather than an error, which reads as "no boxes available".
- **Availability varies sharply by branch** (Dubai, bundle `IN`, 30 Aug): Dubai Central `201` → 0 · Naif `214` → 5 · Al Badaa `233` → 81 · Umm Suqeim `241` → 38 · Al Barsha `244` → 318 · Al Warqa `283` → 9

Reservations we've left stranded

Testing created holds and orders that were never completed, because of the two issues above. If they don't expire on their own, could they be released?

Box	Branch	State
378781, 378785, 378790	Naif (214)	held, no order
449691, 449949, 449989, 450000	Al Barsha (244)	held, no order
450152	Al Barsha (244)	order <code>260961736</code> , unpaid
449922, 449997	Al Barsha (244)	orders <code>260961732</code> , <code>260961735</code> , unpaid
450364	Al Barsha (244)	order <code>260961739</code> , unpaid

The call sequence we're using

Rental/Bundle	<code>request=P</code>	
Rental/BoxLocations	<code>BundleId=IN, EmirateCode=DXB</code>	→ <code>officeId</code> per branch
Rental/FreeBoxes	<code>BundleId=IN, LocationId=<officeId></code>	→ { <code>uniqueBoxId</code> , <code>boxId</code> }
Rental/ExpiryDates	<code>BundleId=IN</code>	→ exact date strings
Rental/Select	<code>bundleId, uniqueBoxID, poBoxExpiryDate</code>	→ <code>subscriptionReferenceNumber</code>
Rental/Save	<code>subscriptionReferenceNumber, totalAmount, userProfile, paymentProperties.billingDetail</code>	

`poBoxExpiryDate` is copied verbatim from `ExpiryDates`, offset included (`2027-08-29T00:00:00+00:00`).
Recomputing it or dropping the offset returns `400 "Invalid date value."`

Happy to jump on a call and walk through it live — we can reproduce both issues on demand.